PORT·BRIEF
Freight intelligence for UK forwarders, importers & logistics managers

Wednesday 30 September 2026
Forecast run 2026-09-30 15:42 UTC

Hamburg and Shanghai gusts build into Monday as reliability slides below 50%

UK gateways look workable through the weekend, with Liverpool's gusts easing from Thursday. The weather risk shifts to Hamburg and Shanghai on Monday 5 October. August reliability fell again: Sea-Intelligence 49.9% (down 5.9 pp), Xeneta 29%.

DETERIORATING IN 3–5 DAYS
2
of 25 ports & lanes tracked

GLOBAL RELIABILITY · SEA-INTELLIGENCE
49.9%
Aug 2026 · -5.9 pp m/m

GLOBAL RELIABILITY · XENETA
29%
Aug 2026 · -4.0 pp m/m

TROPICAL CYCLONES
1
near tracked locations · 10 active worldwide

THE QUESTION THIS ISSUE ANSWERS

Watchlist: where conditions turn next

RISK	PORT / LANE	WHEN	WHY	TREND
▲ WATCH	**Hamburg**	Mon 5 Oct	Gusts to 15.2 m/s on Mon 5 Oct after a blustery Sunday in the German Bight. Intermittent crane stoppages possible; allow slack on Monday cut-offs.	**deteriorating**
▲ WATCH	**Liverpool**	Wed 30 Sep	Gusts reached 17.2 m/s today and ease from Thursday. Watch for knock-on berth delays rather than new stoppages.	improving
▲ WATCH	**Los Angeles / Long Beach**	Wed 30 Sep	Tropical depression POLO-26 is 1027 km away. Local wind and sea stay below our thresholds all week; monitor only.	improving
▲ WATCH	**Western Approaches**	Wed 30 Sep	Seas of 4.5 m today and 4.9 m Thursday, easing to 2.3 m by Saturday. Expect short delays on Atlantic arrivals into the Channel.	improving
▲ WATCH	**Shanghai**	Mon 5 Oct	Gusts to 16.2 m/s on Mon 5 Oct and 14.2 m/s on Tuesday. Crane interruptions possible; build a day into early-week loadings.	**deteriorating**
▲ WATCH	**Mid-North Atlantic**	Wed 30 Sep	4.5 m seas today, easing to 2.3 m by Saturday. Transatlantic delays should be short-lived.	improving
▲ WATCH	**North Pacific (transpacific)**	Sat 3 Oct	Seas of 4.3 m Thursday and 4.1 to 4.2 m over the weekend keep transpacific sailings under pressure.	stable

PORTS · SIX-DAY OPERATIONAL OUTLOOK

UK and North European gateways first

No UK gateway reaches a crane or pilotage threshold in the six-day outlook. Felixstowe, Southampton and London Gateway see gusts of around 13 m/s today, then a quiet weekend. Liverpool touched watch level today with 17.2 m/s gusts but calms from Thursday. The one North European concern is Hamburg on Monday: gusts of 15.2 m/s and seas of 1.7 m follow a windy Sunday in the German Bight. Sinay congestion figures were not available for this issue.

PORT	WED 30	THU 01	FRI 02	SAT 03	SUN 04	MON 05	TUE 06	OCCUPANCY
Felixstowe	13 · 0.9	10 · 0.4	8 · 0.4	7 · 0.4	6 · 0.4	8 · 0.3	10 · 0.3	n/a
Liverpool	▲ 17 · 1.0	12 · 0.7	14 · 1.0	8 · 1.0	8 · 1.1	11 · 0.8	12 · 1.0	n/a
London Gateway	11 · 0.8	10 · 0.3	10 · 0.3	8 · 0.2	8 · 0.3	9 · 0.3	12 · 0.3	n/a
Southampton	12 · 1.1	10 · 0.9	8 · 0.6	6 · 0.3	7 · 0.3	8 · 0.3	13 · 0.3	n/a
Antwerp	10 · 0.5	11 · 0.6	8 · 0.5	5 · 0.2	6 · 0.6	7 · 0.7	10 · 0.6	n/a
Hamburg	12 · 0.7	9 · 0.7	6 · 0.3	7 · 0.9	13 · 1.7	▲ 15 · 1.7	12 · 1.5	n/a
Rotterdam	10 · 0.5	11 · 0.6	6 · 0.4	6 · 0.3	9 · 0.8	9 · 0.8	11 · 0.7	n/a
Los Angeles / Long Beach	11 · 1.3	9 · 1.0	10 · 0.8	7 · 0.8	7 · 0.8	6 · 1.0	7 · 1.1	n/a
Shanghai	13 · 0.7	14 · 0.9	12 · 0.8	8 · 0.5	14 · 0.9	▲ 16 · 1.1	14 · 0.8	n/a
Singapore	8 · 0.1	8 · 0.0	8 · 0.0	8 · 0.0	10 · 0.1	10 · 0.2	10 · 0.1	n/a

Cells: peak gust m/s · peak sea m (UTC days). ▲ Watch ◆ Likely — crane stoppages from gusts ≥ 15 / 20 m/s; pilot boarding from sea ≥ 2.5 / 3.5 m or long-period swell. Occupancy: Sinay berth occupancy (gap vs port's usual level, pp).

LANES & CHOKEPOINTS

Sea state on the routes into Europe

Atlantic weather is the near-term story. The Western Approaches and mid-North Atlantic are both at watch level today with seas around 4.5 m, but both ease sharply by the weekend, so westbound delays should be brief. Biscay peaks at 3.9 m on Thursday, below our threshold. Further afield, the North Pacific stays rough for transpacific sailings, and off the Cape a south-westerly swell builds to 4 m by Tuesday 6 October. The Taiwan Strait turns windy from Monday, with gusts of 22.3 m/s. Of ten active tropical cyclones, only POLO-26 is within 1,200 km of a location we track.

LANE	WED 30	THU 01	FRI 02	SAT 03	SUN 04	MON 05	TUE 06
Bay of Biscay	3.8 · 13	3.9 · 10	3.6 · 8	2.4 · 9	1.8 · 10	1.5 · 10	1.3 · 7
Dover Strait	1.2 · 11	0.9 · 9	0.7 · 7	0.3 · 5	0.6 · 6	0.5 · 7	0.4 · 7
Western Approaches	▲ 4.5 · 14	▲ 4.9 · 10	3.8 · 9	2.3 · 5	1.5 · 3	1.3 · 6	1.8 · 6
German Bight	0.9 · 10	0.8 · 10	0.4 · 6	1.0 · 7	1.8 · 10	1.8 · 11	1.6 · 9
Strait of Gibraltar	0.9 · 3	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 10	1.0 · 8	1.0 · 7	1.0 · 5	0.8 · 3
Arabian Sea	1.2 · 2	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 5	1.0 · 4	0.9 · 3	0.9 · 2
Bab-el-Mandeb / Gulf of Aden	0.8 · 9	0.8 · 7	0.9 · 9	1.2 · 9	1.3 · 10	1.1 · 9	1.1 · 9
Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas	3.5 · 16	3.3 · 11	2.5 · 11	2.6 · 10	2.7 · 13	2.7 · 9	▲ 4.0 · 14
Mid-North Atlantic	▲ 4.5 · 13	3.6 · 12	2.8 · 8	2.3 · 6	1.5 · 8	1.4 · 5	1.7 · 9
North Pacific (transpacific)	3.4 · 13	▲ 4.3 · 15	2.9 · 14	▲ 4.1 · 13	▲ 4.2 · 11	3.0 · 7	2.4 · 10
Panama approaches (Colón)	1.0 · 4	1.0 · 6	0.9 · 4	0.8 · 6	0.7 · 5	0.7 · 5	0.6 · 4
South of Sri Lanka	1.6 · 8	1.7 · 6	1.6 · 4	1.5 · 4	1.4 · 4	1.3 · 3	1.3 · 2

Strait of Malacca	0.4 · 6	0.1 · 5	0.1 · 4	0.1 · 4	0.1 · 6	0.0 · 4	0.1 · 3
Suez approaches (Port Said)	1.0 · 7	0.8 · 7	0.6 · 9	0.5 · 7	0.5 · 4	0.4 · 5	0.4 · 4
Taiwan Strait	0.3 · 4	0.4 · 8	1.6 · 12	1.4 · 10	0.9 · 8	3.2 · 16	3.2 · 15

Cells: peak sea m · peak wind m/s. ▲ Watch (sea ≥ 4 m or gale) ◆ Likely (sea ≥ 6 m or severe gale). Agulhas also flags south-west swell against the current.

Forecast drift since the last run

No material change versus the previous forecast (or no previous run to compare).

Tropical cyclones

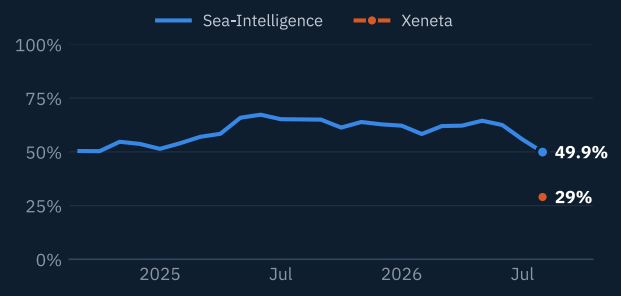
STORM	STRENGTH	NEAREST TRACKED
POLO-26	Tropical Depression	Los Angeles / Long Beach · 1027 km
NOLO-26	Tropical Storm	none within 1,200 km
RACHEL-26	Hurricane/ Typhoon > 74 mph	none within 1,200 km
HANNA-26	Tropical Depression	none within 1,200 km
NINETEEN-E-26	Tropical Depression	none within 1,200 km

SCHEDULE RELIABILITY · MONTHLY, ~4–6 WEEKS LAGGED

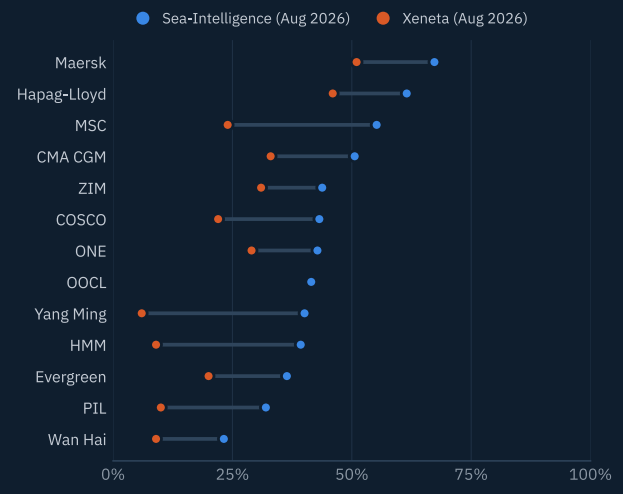
Two benchmarks, two definitions of on time

Sea-Intelligence puts August global schedule reliability at 49.9%, down 5.9 pp on July and 15.2 pp on a year ago, with late vessels arriving 6.81 days behind schedule on average. Xeneta measures 29%, down 4 pp. The 20.9 pp gap is methodology, not error: Sea-Intelligence counts an arrival as on time within one day of schedule, while Xeneta counts only arrivals on the scheduled day. The two agree at the top, with Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd first and second on both. They disagree most on Yang Ming: 40.1% against 6%.

Global on-time share



Carriers: same month, two methods



CARRIER	SEA-INTELLIGENCE AUG 2026	RANK	XENETA AUG 2026	RANK	GAP

Maersk	67.3%	1	51%	1	+16.3 pp
Hapag-Lloyd	61.5%	2	46%	2	+15.5 pp
MSC	55.2%	3	24%	6	+31.2 pp
CMA CGM	50.6%	4	33%	3	+17.6 pp
ZIM	43.8%	5	31%	4	+12.8 pp
COSCO	43.2%	6	22%	7	+21.2 pp
ONE	42.8%	7	29%	5	+13.8 pp
OOCL	41.5%	8	–		
Yang Ming	40.1%	9	6%	12	+34.1 pp
HMM	39.3%	10	9%	11	+30.3 pp
Evergreen	36.4%	11	20%	8	+16.4 pp
PIL	32.0%	12	10%	9	+22.0 pp
Wan Hai	23.2%	13	9%	10	+14.2 pp

Sea-Intelligence: Share of vessel arrivals within one day of scheduled arrival; 34 trade lanes, 60+ carriers (GLP report). Average delay for late arrivals 6.81 days.

Xeneta: Share of vessel arrivals on the scheduled day (eeSea data); Xeneta Ocean Benchmark. Xeneta ranks 12 carriers (OOCL is not listed separately).

Gap = Sea-Intelligence minus Xeneta, percentage points. Different definitions of 'on time' and different vessel samples; the gap is expected and is itself informative.

PORT & CARRIER NOTICES · PAST SEVEN DAYS

Advisories

Two routing moves stand out. Maersk and Hapag-Lloyd plan to resume Suez Canal routing on the AE12 service from 27 October, and Hapag-Lloyd is reported to be restoring Suez transits on its India to US East Coast service. Surcharges keep building: Maersk peak season surcharges on South America to Europe (USD 500) and Europe to South Africa, a CMA CGM reefer surcharge from South America to North Europe, and new FAK rates from MSC and CMA CGM on Asia to Europe and the Mediterranean.

Ports

Temporary transformer in Europoort relieves grid congestion · Port of Rotterdam · 2026-09-25 · official site

Carriers

Maersk implements USD 500 peak season surcharge on South America-Europe routes · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · Data Portuaria

Maersk implements peak season surcharge on Europe-South Africa route · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · Data Portuaria

Europe to West Africa Service Enhancement 30 Sep 2026 · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · official site

NEW MSC announces new Far East to Europe FAK rates · MSC · 2026-09-29 · container-news.com

NEW MSC introduces surcharge from Europe to Middle East · MSC · 2026-09-29 · container-news.com

Hapag-Lloyd to resume Suez transits for India-USEC service: sources · Hapag-Lloyd · 2026-09-30 · Journal of Commerce

Maersk, Hapag-Lloyd to resume Suez Canal routing for AE12 service from 27 October - Urban & Transport - Egypt · Hapag-Lloyd · 2026-09-29 · Ahram Online

CMA CGM raises Asia–Mediterranean FAK rates · CMA CGM · 2026-09-30 · container-news.com

CMA CGM adds reefer surcharge from South America to North Europe · CMA CGM · 2026-09-30 · container-news.com

Sources, method & data health

Weather is treated as a leading indicator: flags mark days when forecast wind or sea state reach levels at which crane work or pilot boarding is commonly suspended, or heavy weather slows transits. They are probabilistic signals, not port notices; always confirm with your terminal or carrier.

Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0).

Data health this run: marine weather **ok** · cyclones **ok** · sinay congestion **skipped** · schedule reliability **ok** · advisories **ok**.